

National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey

2017-2018 Data Documentation, Codebook, and Frequencies

Mental Health - Depression Screener (DPQ_J)

Data File: DPQ_J.xpt

First Published: February 2020

Last Revised: NA

Component Description

A nine-item depression screening instrument (variable prefix is DPQ), also called the Patient Health Questionnaire (Kroenke and Spitzer, 2002; Kroenke et al., 2001) was administered to determine the frequency of depression symptoms over the past 2 weeks. For each symptom question, points ranging from 0 to 3, are associated with the response categories "not at all," "several days," "more than half the days," and "nearly every day." This screening instrument incorporates DSM-IV depression diagnostic criteria (Spitzer et al.,1999).

Eligible Sample

Participants aged 12 years and over were eligible. Only data from participants aged 18 and older are included in this data file. Participants requiring a proxy were not eligible because of the sensitive nature of the questions. Data for youth aged 12-17 years are available through the NCHS Research Data Center.

Interview Setting and Mode of Administration

The questions were asked at the Mobile Examination Center (MEC), by trained interviewers, using the Computer-Assisted Personal Interview (CAPI) system as part of the MEC interview.

Quality Assurance & Quality Control

The CAPI system is programmed with built-in consistency checks to reduce data entry errors.

Data Processing and Editing

Edits were made to ensure completeness, consistency and analytic usefulness of the data.

Analytic Notes

A total score, ranging from 0 to 27, can be calculated for persons who have complete responses to the symptom questions. Major depression and depression severity can be assessed using pre-defined cut-points, described in the references that follow.

The NHANES full sample 2-Year MEC Exam Weights (WTMEC2YR) should be used to analyze these data.

Please refer to the [NHANES Analytic Guidelines](#) and the on-line [NHANES Tutorial](#) for further details on the use of sample weights and other analytic issues.

References

- Kroenke K, Spitzer RL, William JB. The PHQ-9: validity of a brief depression severity measure. J Gen Intern Med 2001; 16: 1606-13.
- Kroenke K, Spitzer RL. The PHQ-9: a new depression and diagnostic severity measure. Psych Annals 2002; 32:509-21.
- Spitzer RL, Kroenke K, Williams JB. Validation and utility of a self-report version of Prime MD: the PHQ primary care study. JAMA 1999; 282: 1737-44.

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SEQN - Respondent sequence number

Variable Name:	SEQN
SAS Label:	Respondent sequence number
English Text:	Respondent sequence number.
Target:	Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

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DPQ010 - Have little interest in doing things

Variable Name: DPQ010

SAS Label: Have little interest in doing things

English Text: Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems: little interest or pleasure in doing things? Would you say...

English Instructions: HAND CARD DPQ1

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0	Not at all	3792	3792	
1	Several days	816	4608	
2	More than half the days	280	4888	
3	Nearly every day	198	5086	
7	Refused	4	5090	
9	Don't know	4	5094	
.	Missing	439	5533	

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DPQ020 - Feeling down, depressed, or hopeless

Variable Name: DPQ020

SAS Label: Feeling down, depressed, or hopeless

English Text: [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] feeling down, depressed, or hopeless?

English Instructions: HAND CARD DPQ1

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0	Not at all	3865	3865	
1	Several days	831	4696	
2	More than half the days	224	4920	
3	Nearly every day	167	5087	
7	Refused	2	5089	
9	Don't know	4	5093	
.	Missing	440	5533	

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DPQ030 - Trouble sleeping or sleeping too much

Variable Name: DPQ030

SAS Label: Trouble sleeping or sleeping too much

English Text: [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] trouble falling or staying asleep, or sleeping too much?

English Instructions: HAND CARD DPQ1

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0	Not at all	3119	3119	
1	Several days	1141	4260	
2	More than half the days	383	4643	
3	Nearly every day	443	5086	
7	Refused	3	5089	
9	Don't know	4	5093	
.	Missing	440	5533	

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DPQ040 - Feeling tired or having little energy

Variable Name: DPQ040

SAS Label: Feeling tired or having little energy

English Text: [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] feeling tired or having little energy?

English Instructions: HAND CARD DPQ1

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0	Not at all	2584	2584	
1	Several days	1612	4196	
2	More than half the days	457	4653	
3	Nearly every day	432	5085	
7	Refused	3	5088	
9	Don't know	4	5092	
.	Missing	441	5533	

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DPQ050 - Poor appetite or overeating

Variable Name: DPQ050

SAS Label: Poor appetite or overeating

English Text: [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] poor appetite or overeating?

English Instructions: HAND CARD DPQ1

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0	Not at all	3812	3812	
1	Several days	778	4590	
2	More than half the days	276	4866	
3	Nearly every day	221	5087	
7	Refused	2	5089	
9	Don't know	3	5092	
.	Missing	441	5533	

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DPQ060 - Feeling bad about yourself

Variable Name: DPQ060

SAS Label: Feeling bad about yourself

English Text: [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] feeling bad about yourself - or that you are a failure or have let yourself or your family down?

English Instructions: HAND CARD DPQ1

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0	Not at all	4237	4237	
1	Several days	575	4812	
2	More than half the days	147	4959	
3	Nearly every day	124	5083	
7	Refused	3	5086	
9	Don't know	5	5091	
.	Missing	442	5533	

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DPQ070 - Trouble concentrating on things

Variable Name: DPQ070

SAS Label: Trouble concentrating on things

English Text: [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] trouble concentrating on things, such as reading the newspaper or watching TV?

English Instructions: HAND CARD DPQ1

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0	Not at all	4241	4241	
1	Several days	517	4758	
2	More than half the days	156	4914	
3	Nearly every day	172	5086	
7	Refused	2	5088	
9	Don't know	3	5091	
.	Missing	442	5533	

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DPQ080 - Moving or speaking slowly or too fast

Variable Name: DPQ080

SAS Label: Moving or speaking slowly or too fast

English Text: [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] moving or speaking so slowly that other people could have noticed? Or the opposite - being so fidgety or restless that you have been moving around a lot more than usual?

English Instructions: HAND CARD DPQ1

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0	Not at all	4541	4541	
1	Several days	328	4869	
2	More than half the days	120	4989	
3	Nearly every day	95	5084	
7	Refused	2	5086	
9	Don't know	5	5091	
.	Missing	442	5533	

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DPQ090 - Thought you would be better off dead

Variable Name: DPQ090

SAS Label: Thought you would be better off dead

English Text: [Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems:] Thoughts that you would be better off dead or of hurting yourself in some way?

English Instructions: HAND CARD DPQ1

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0	Not at all	4893	4893	
1	Several days	136	5029	
2	More than half the days	32	5061	
3	Nearly every day	24	5085	
7	Refused	2	5087	
9	Don't know	3	5090	
.	Missing	443	5533	

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DPQ100 - Difficulty these problems have caused

Variable Name: DPQ100

SAS Label: Difficulty these problems have caused

English Text: How difficult have these problems made it for you to do your work, take care of things at home, or get along with people?

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0	Not at all difficult,	2480	2480	
1	Somewhat difficult,	714	3194	
2	Very difficult,	132	3326	
3	Extremely difficult	33	3359	
7	Refused	1	3360	
9	Don't know	2	3362	
.	Missing	2171	5533	

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